Anna University M.E. Project Report: Format Guide

Project: Auditable AI Agents
Prepared: 2026-10-30
Read this first: I could not find one official, current Anna University M.E. report manual online. This guide is built from the two most authoritative documents I could open and read in full:

1. **Anna University, Centre for Distance Education:** "Guidelines for Preparation of MCA Project Report (Prescribed Format and Specification)", an official Anna University document (cde.annauniv.edu/pdf/MCA/report.pdf). It is for MCA, but the layout rules are the university's standard ones.
2. **Panimalar Engineering College:** "Guidelines for Preparation of M.E./M.Tech Phase I Report and Phase II Thesis", an Anna-affiliated college's manual written specifically for M.E. (Panimalar-PG-Thesis-Format.pdf).

The two agree on almost every layout rule; where they differ I say so. **Your own department's manual always wins.** Take this guide to your project coordinator and confirm the rows marked "confirm".

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1. Report types

Report	When	Minimum size (Chapter 1 to last appendix page)
Phase I report	First project phase	25 pages
Phase II thesis	Final project phase	40 pages, with more weight on results and discussion

The official MCA guideline instead caps its report at 60 pages; confirm whether your department sets a minimum, a maximum or both.

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2. Order of contents (bound in this order)

#	Item	Notes
1	Cover page and title page	Specimen in section 8
2	Bonafide certificate	Supervisor and HOD signatures
3	Abstract	English and Tamil
4	Acknowledgement	Maximum one page
5	Table of contents	
6	List of tables	
7	List of figures	
8	List of symbols, abbreviations and nomenclature	Optional
9	Chapters	
10	Appendices	

#	Item	Notes
11	References	

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3. Page, margins, paper

Item	Rule
Paper	A4 (297 x 210 mm); bound size 290 x 205 mm
Top margin	30 to 35 mm
Bottom margin	25 to 30 mm
Left margin	35 to 40 mm (binding side)
Right margin	20 to 25 mm
Paper quality	Good white paper, not lighter than 80 gsm
Ink	Black
Tables and figures	Must fit inside the margins

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4. Typing

Item	Rule
Font	Times New Roman
General text size	13 pt (Panimalar M.E. manual). The official MCA guideline uses 12 pt for certificate and abstract. Confirm 12 or 13.
General text spacing	1.5 lines
Single spacing	Long tables, long quotations, footnotes, multi-line captions, references
Double spacing	Bonafide certificate, acknowledgement, abstract
Quotations over one line	Indented 15 mm from both margins
Corrections	Not permitted in submitted copies
Sub-heading at page bottom	Needs at least two lines below it, else move to next page
Hyphenation	Do not split the last word of a page with a hyphen

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5. Headings and page layout

Element	Rule
Headings of items 2 to 10	CAPITALS, no punctuation, centred, 50 mm below top of page; text starts four spaces below

Element	Rule
Chapter opening	The word CHAPTER (no punctuation) centred 50 mm from the top; two spaces below, the chapter title in capitals, centred; text starts four spaces below the title
Division and sub-division headings	Left-justified, with number, starting 20 mm from the left margin
Paragraphs	First letter offset 20 mm from the left margin; paragraphs start three spaces below the previous one
Title and chapter headings	Same format as in the table of contents

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6. Numbering

What	Rule
Page numbers	No punctuation, top right corner, 20 mm from the top, last digit aligned with the right margin
Preliminary pages (items 1 to 8)	Lower-case Roman numerals; the title page counts as (i) but the number is not printed
Main text	Arabic numerals starting at Chapter 1, page 1
Chapters, divisions	Decimal: division 4 under division 3 of chapter 2 is 2.3.4
Tables and figures	By chapter: the 4th figure in chapter 3 is Figure 3.4; tables likewise
Appendix figures	Figure 3 in Appendix 2 is Figure A 2.3
Equations	Restart each chapter: the 8th equation of chapter 2 is (2.8), cited as Equation (2.8)
Appendices	Appendix 1, Appendix 2 and so on

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7. Tables, figures, references

Element	Rule
Table caption	Above the table, left-aligned, sentence case ("Table 3.1 Test results")
Figure caption	Below the figure, centred, sentence case
Placement	Near where first cited; on the same page if half a page or less, separated from text by triple spacing
Continued table	Caption "Table 2.1 (continued)", centred and underlined; no line under an unfinished table
In-text citation	Author-year: (Tsychiya 1980), Jankins and Walts (1968), Shin et al. (1984)
Reference list	Heading REFERENCES; alphabetical by first author; single spacing, left-justified
Reference entry	Authors (year), 'Title', Journal, Vol., No., pp.
Your own publications	Not in the references; list them in an appendix titled List of Publications

The Panimalar manual uses the author-year style above, not IEEE numbers. Your IEEE conference paper (see `docs/thesis/ieee-abstract.md`*) still uses IEEE numbering; the report follows the college style.* ***Confirm*** *that your department accepts author-year.*

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8. Specimen pages

Title page (Times New Roman, bold; all centred):

Line	Size
TITLE OF THESIS	18 pt, 1.5 spacing
A THESIS (or PHASE I REPORT)	14 pt
Submitted by	14 pt, italic
NAME OF THE CANDIDATE	16 pt
in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of	14 pt, 1.5 spacing
MASTER OF ENGINEERING IN [PROGRAMME]	16 pt
DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING	16 pt, 1.5 spacing
COLLEGE NAME, (affiliation line)	16 pt / 12 pt
MONTH AND YEAR	14 pt

Bonafide certificate: college name 18 pt, affiliation line 12 pt, BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE 16 pt, body 13 pt. Wording: *Certified that this [Report/Thesis] titled "TITLE" is the bonafide work of NAME (Register No.) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.* Two signature blocks: the supervisor (name, academic designation, department, address) and the Head of Department.

Table of contents: heading 14 pt; columns CHAPTER NO., TITLE, PAGE NO.; the abstract, lists and chapters listed with their page numbers (roman for the front matter, Arabic for chapters).

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9. Binding and copies

Item	Panimalar M.E. manual	Anna University CDE (MCA)
Binding	Flexible cover of thick white art paper; cover printed in black; text identical to the title page	Not stated in the part I read
Copies	3 (student, supervisor, department library)	5 for evaluation

Confirm the number of copies and binding colour with your department. Many colleges require a colour cover and a CD.

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10. Chapter outline expected

	Phase I report	Phase II thesis
Ch. 1	Introduction	Introduction
Ch. 2	Literature review	Literature review

	Phase I report	**Phase II thesis**
Ch. 3	Theoretical background / concepts / methodology / design / modelling	Same
Further	Project implementation and results, as applicable	Results of analysis, design, modelling, simulation or experiments, and discussion
Final	Conclusions and work schedule for Phase II	Conclusions and scope for future work
After	Appendices (if any); References (also cited in the text)	Same

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11. What is prepared for you

File	**What it is**
docs/report/phase1-report.md	The full Phase I report text (Markdown source)
docs/report/config.json	Your details: name, register number, supervisor, college; fill the placeholders
docs/report/Phase1-Report.docx	Word version in the format above (margins, fonts, spacing, numbering, caption rules)
docs/report/Phase1-Report-preview.pdf	PDF preview with the same layout, for page-count and visual check
assets/figures/	The report's figures
docs/anna-university/checklist.md	Final submission checklist

Rebuild after any edit: `node scripts/build_report_docx.js` and `python scripts/report_pdf.py`.

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12. Things to confirm with your coordinator

1. Font size, 12 or 13 pt.
2. Number of copies and cover colour.
3. Whether author-year references are accepted, or IEEE numbering is wanted.
4. Whether the Tamil abstract is required for M.E.
5. The exact college name, affiliation line and address for the cover and certificate.
6. Phase I minimum page count and review dates.
7. Plagiarism-check limit and any department template (a Word `.dotx`) they provide, which you should use if they have one.